Tracking Antisemitic and Anti-LGBTQ+ Hate Crimes in the U.S.

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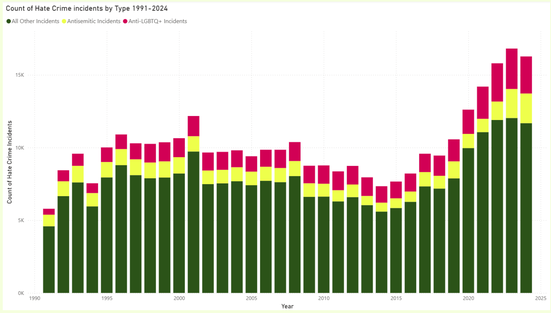
Introduction

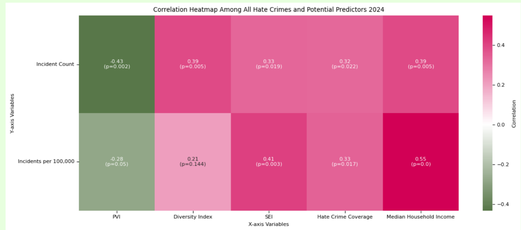
Over the past 10 years, there has been a stark increase in hate crime incidents in the United States, disproportionate to national population growth. The rise in antisemitic and anti-LGBTQ+ hate crime activity has been particularly notable. The main objective is to investigate in-depth factors which may be correlated with this rise in hate crimes as a whole, and more specifically with antisemitic and anti-LBGTQ+ incidents.



Data Sources

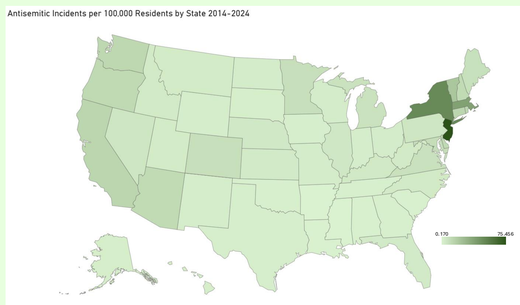
- **FBI:** The FBI's Hate Crime Statistics report records the offense type; bias type; and geographic, offender, and victim data for each hate crime reported by local agencies.
- **Anti-Defamation League:** Reports antisemitic hate crimes and detailed information about each incident; includes information on the GDL.
- **U.S. Census Bureau:** Reports demographic data, including population and household income information, and the Diversity Index (a measure of racial/ethnic diversity) per state.
- **Jewish Public Library:** Reports the total U.S. Jewish population and Jewish population per state.
- **World Population Review:** Reports each state's Political Voting Index (PVI), which describes the degree to which the state's votes lean Democratic or Republican.
- **Human Rights Campaign:** Reports the State Equality Index (SEI), a measure of how LGBTQ+ protective a state's laws are.
- **Movement Advancement Project:** Reports the degree to which sexual orientation and gender identity are covered as protected classes in a state's hate crime laws.
- **American Civil Liberties Union:** Reports the number of anti-LGBTQ+ bills introduced in each state every year.

All Hate Crimes

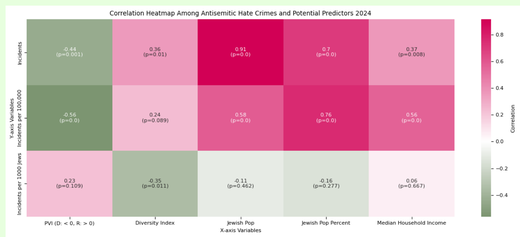


Simple correlation analysis among 2024 data reveals a statistically significant correlation between a state's number of hate crime incidents per 100,000 residents and its Political Voting Index, State Equality Index, and degree of hate crime protections. Considering each factor separately, states with a more Democratic-leaning PVI, states with higher LGBTQ+ legal equality, and states with stronger hate crime protections report higher numbers of hate crimes per 100,000 residents. This is likely because such states tend to have more robust hate crime reporting procedures than Republican-leaning states with low LGBTQ+ equality and hate crime protections.

Antisemitic Hate Crimes



Reported antisemitic hate crimes per 100,000 residents from 2014-2024 were most highly concentrated in New Jersey (75.46), New York (46.68), and Massachusetts (28.26). The states with the lowest reported incidents were Arkansas (0.39), Alabama (0.35), and Mississippi (0.17).

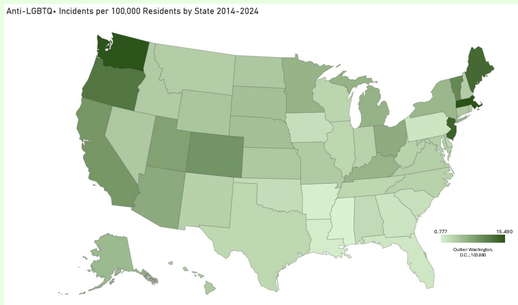


This correlation heatmap reveals which variables are correlated with the number of reported antisemitic incidents per state in 2024. There are statistically significant correlations between the number of incidents and a state's Political Voting Index, Diversity Index, Jewish population, and median household income.

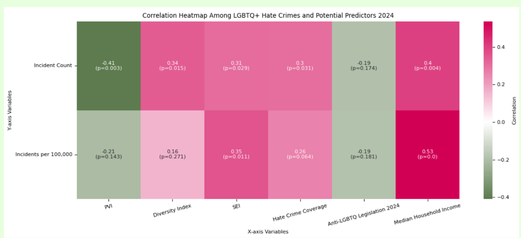
The **Goyim Defense League** was associated with **864 (~5%)** of the ADL reported antisemitic incidents from 2023-2024.

The Goyim Defense League (GDL) is a white supremacist, antisemitic neo-Nazi group that mainly aims to "expel jews from America" (ADL). One of their claims is that the U.S. government consists of "all anti-white Jewish Villains." In December 2020, the GDL started its 'Every single aspect of XXX is Jewish' campaign. Inputs include 'Disney child grooming', 'the LGBTQ movement', 'the covid agenda', 'the slave trade', 'gun control', 'the media', 'the Biden administration', and 'feminism'.

Anti-LGBTQ+ Hate Crimes



Reported anti-LGBTQ+ hate crimes per 100,000 residents from 2014-2024 were most highly concentrated in Washington, D.C. (103.88); Massachusetts (15.49); and Washington (15.35). The states with the lowest reported incidents per 100,000 residents were Louisiana (1.38), Arkansas (1.16), and Mississippi (0.78).



Simple correlation analysis among 2024 data reveals statistically significant correlations between a state's number of reported anti-LGBTQ+ hate crime incidents and its Political Voting Index, Diversity Index, State Equality Index, hate crime coverage, and median household income.

This analysis further reveals that a state's number of reported anti-LGBTQ+ hate crime incidents per 100,000 residents has a statistically significant correlation with its State Equality Index and a moderately significant correlation with its hate crime coverage, meaning that states with higher LGBTQ+ legal equality and coverage of sexual orientation and gender identity as protected classes report higher numbers of hate crimes per 100,000 residents. This is likely because such states tend to have more robust hate crime reporting procedures, especially for anti-LGBTQ+ crimes, than states with low LGBTQ+ equality and hate crime protections.

Ethical Implications

The amount of fear, hatred, and social unrest has been on the rise in the United States. Jewish Temples are being attacked, queer and transgender individuals are being violently targeted, and so much more. Many Americans are in a constant state of fear by simply existing. As the rise of hate crimes continues, it is critical that actions be taken to protect victims and prevent future crimes. Hate crime protection laws must be stricter and hate crime incident investigation and reporting must be improved.

Implications for Stakeholders

Stakeholders in this research include Jewish and LGBTQ+ Americans, legislators and policymakers, law enforcement, lawyers and activist organizations. Additionally, all American citizens are impacted by these incidents because the proliferation of hate-motivated crimes threatens individual/group safety and national unity. This issue affects everyone.

Understanding the factors which correlate with antisemitic and anti-LGBTQ+ hate crimes is necessary for implementing effective preventative and protective measures. Without this understanding, the rate of these incidents will continue to rise.

Future Directions

We plan to expand this research by computing machine learning models to predict reported antisemitic or LGBTQ+ hate crimes based on each state's Political Voting Index, Diversity Index, State Equality Index, hate crime coverage, and other state-level factors, including:

- Average education level
- Age distribution
- Population density